



HYDRATION IS ESSENTIAL



our bodies NEED fluids

60-70% of the human body is made up of water. We consistently experience fluid loss through sweat, our breath, bowel movements, and urination, so constant replenishment is necessary.

WHAT WATER DOES

- Maintain the balance of body fluids
- Aid digestion, absorption, and transportation of nutrients
- Promote circulation
- Maintain body temperature

Not drinking enough fluids can lead to dehydration or over-heating. When we are physically active or the weather is hot, we need to be especially careful because water loss occurs more rapidly. A loss of just 2% of bodyweight due to dehydration will negatively impact how our bodies perform resulting in fatigue, reduced ability to make decisions and electrolyte imbalance.

SYMPTOMS OF DEHYDRATION

- Headache
- Dizziness
- Thirst
- Blurred vision
- Inability to focus
- Urine is a dark color
- Waking body weight is lower than usual

WHY WATER IS ESSENTIAL TO OVERALL HEALTH WEIGHT LOSS

Water can boost your metabolic rate. Studies have shown that drinking 16 oz of water can increase your metabolism by 24-30% for up to 1 1/2 hours. This means 2 liters of water everyday can increase your total energy expenditure by up to 96 calories per day.

Drinking 30 minutes before meals can make you feel full which can help with portion control. A good hunger test is to drink a glass of water and wait 15 minutes before grabbing a snack. If the hunger pangs are still there, go ahead and eat.

ENERGY LEVELS & BRAIN FUNCTION

Fluid loss of 1-3% has been shown to impair concentration, memory, and moods by increasing feelings of anxiety and fatigue.

FLUSHES OUT TOXINS

Water helps move toxins from the body through sweat, bowel movements, and urine. We store toxins in fat cells so as we lose fat mass, drinking water will help to move the toxins out more efficiently.

GLOWING SKIN

Dehydration makes your skin look more dry and wrinkled so drink up for a dewy glow.

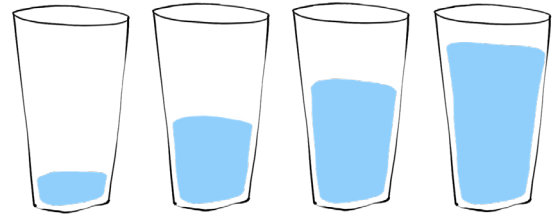
RELIEVE CONSTIPATION

Adequate hydration promotes a healthy GI tract and prevents constipation. When you don't get enough fluid, the colon pulls water from the stools to maintain hydration and the result is constipation. It is particularly important to increase water if increasing fiber. Carbonated water has been shown to be effective in relieving mild constipation.

OPTIMIZES PHYSICAL PERFORMANCE

Dehydration decreases physical and mental performance due to altered body temperature control and increased fatigue. Dehydration is more likely to occur when physical activity is intense or when there is high heat and humidity. It is not uncommon for athletes to lose 6-10% of their water through sweat. Remember that muscles 80% water. The goal is to be well hydrated before the start of any physical activity. Start drinking water an hour before and continue to drink throughout the activity whether you are thirsty or not. Any sweat loss should be replaced immediately following exercise.

HOW TO INCREASE WATER INTAKE



ADD WATER

Add a bit of excitement by adding fresh fruit (lime, strawberries, lemon), veggie slices (cucumber or celery), and herbs (basil, mint, lavender, or ginger) to your carafe.

MAKE IT PART OF YOUR ROUTINE

Start a habit by linking water with some of your most common daily activities. Getting up from your desk for a bathroom break? Stop by the kitchen to drink a glass of water after leaving the restroom. Every time you pass the water cooler, fill up a cup. Or set an alarm on your phone to remind you to drink every 30-60 minutes.

HYDRATING FOODS

Vegetables and soups are good choices.

GO ONE-FOR-ONE

For every alcoholic cocktail, drink one glass of water. This is a great strategy to avoid a hangover the next day and to take in fewer empty calories. Try a wine spritzer - 1/2 wine and 1/2 seltzer or clear liquor like vodka or tequila with club soda and fresh lime. These options provide extra H₂O and don't include sugar-packed mixers and syrups.

